YEWON CHO



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Google Scholar

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Large Language Models (LLMs), Reinforcement Learning for LLMs, Korean LLM Post-Training & Evaluation, Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG), Inference Optimization

EDUCATION

Korea University, Seoul, South Korea *Mar 2025 – Feb 2027 (Expected)*
M.S. in Computer Science (Advisor: Prof. Jaewoo Kang); GPA: 4.44/4.5

Korea University, Seoul, South Korea *Mar 2020 – Feb 2025*
B.S. in Mathematics; GPA: 3.78/4.5
B.Eng. in Interdisciplinary Major in Artificial Intelligence

PUBLICATIONS

1. **Adaptive Latent Block Insertion via Online Reward Optimization**.
Yewon Cho, Hyeongsoon Hwang, Yein Park, Hyeon Hwang, Jaewoo Kang.
EMNLP 2026 Main Conference. [Paper]

2. **Prompting Matters: Snippet-Aware Strategies for Biomedical QA with LLMs in BioASQ 13b**.
Hajung Kim†, Hoonick Lee†, **Yewon Cho**†, Jungwoo Park†, Jueon Park†, Soyon Park†, Yan Ting Chok†, Seungheun Baek†, Donghyeon Lee†, Jaewoo Kang.
CLEF 2025 Working Notes. [Paper]

3. **Exploring Model Personalities: Utilizing Self-Awareness to Analyze Behavioral Characteristics of Large Language Models**.
Yewon Cho, Jongmyung Jung, Hyeongsoon Hwang, Yein Park, Chanwoong Yoon, Jaewoo Kang.
Proceedings of KCC 2025. [Paper]

4. **Assessing LLM Reasoning Steps via Principal Knowledge Grounding**.
Hyeon Hwang, **Yewon Cho**, Chanwoong Yoon, Yein Park, Minju Song, Kyungjae Lee, Gangwoo Kim, Jaewoo Kang.
EMNLP 2025 Findings. [Paper]

† Equal contribution

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Personalized Cultural Heritage Storytelling AI Feb 2025 – Dec 2026
Researcher; LLM Workstream Lead since Jan 2026 *ETRI-funded R&D Project*

· Built a Korean RAG pipeline over **75,341 documents** and synthesized **74K Korean multi-turn dialogues** for Gemma fine-tuning, leading end-to-end conversational LLM development and expert-in-the-loop evaluation.

AI-based Fake News Detection System May 2026 – Oct 2026
Team Lead *KETI gPBL Program*

· Built a two-stage claim verification pipeline combining Elasticsearch–SVM retrieval with RAG/LLM evidence reasoning, optimizing accuracy, latency, and inference cost (awarded KRW 2.5M gPBL grant).

ATEC2026 Real-World Extreme Challenge Jun 2026 – Sep 2026
Team Lead *ATEC2026*

· Led RL and imitation learning policy training for locomotion and manipulation, earning a USD 1,756 online prize and deploying sim-to-real policies on physical robots at the Hong Kong finals.

3D Dance Motion Generation Improvement Dec 2023 – Feb 2024
Research Intern *Korea Institute of Science and Technology (KIST)*

· Revised Bailando's Actor–Critic reward to preserve valid seated motions after analyzing its VQ-VAE and Motion GPT pipeline.

HONORS & AWARDS

1st Place, BioASQ 13b Challenge (Task B) *2025*
Achieved first place in the biomedical question answering task at BioASQ 13b.

ATEC2026 Online Qualifier Prize & Hong Kong On-Site Finalist *2026*
Advanced to the Hong Kong on-site round and received a USD 1,756 prize.

National Science & Engineering Graduate Scholarship (MSIT) *Mar 2025 – Present*
KRW 2,500,000 per semester.

KETI gPBL Fellowship (Korea Electronics Technology Institute) *2026*
KRW 2,500,000 research fellowship.

National Scholarship for Science and Engineering Students *Mar 2020 – Feb 2025*
Seven-semester full-tuition merit scholarship.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming & Infra	Python, FastAPI, Docker, Linux, Git
ML / LLM	PyTorch (Multi-GPU Training), Hugging Face Transformers, vLLM, Isaac Sim, scikit-learn
Retrieval / Search	FAISS, Elasticsearch
Methods	Korean LLM Fine-Tuning, RL for Reasoning, RAG, Synthetic Data, LLM Evaluation & Benchmarking

LANGUAGES

Korean: Native — **English**: OPIc IH (Intermediate High, Aug 2026)